

:# Linux as a Windows screensaver

:** Linux as a Windows screensaver** is a software project that enables a Linux distribution to run as a screensaver on Microsoft Windows systems. The project allows customization of the Linux distribution with boot splash screens and wallpapers featuring organizational branding.

:## Overview

:The project demonstrates the integration of a complete Linux operating system within the Windows screensaver framework. When activated, the screensaver boots a Linux distribution in a virtualized environment, displaying the Linux desktop or custom graphics as the screensaver content.

:## Implementation

:A tutorial published on IBM Developer describes the technical process for building a Windows screensaver based on a Linux distribution.<ref>{{cite web |title=Build a Linux distribution as a Microsoft Windows screen saver |url=https://developer.ibm.com/tutorials/awb-build-linux-dist-as-a-ms-windows-screen-saver/ |access-date=2026-05-19 |publisher=IBM Developer}}</ref> The implementation involves customizing the Linux distribution with specific boot splash screens and wallpaper images.

:## Publications and media

:The concept has been documented in several publications:

:* An article on Linux.com discussing the project in the context of open source software and Software Bill of Materials (SBOM)<ref>{{cite web |title=Linux as a screensaver for Windows: The gift of open source games and SBOMs for the holidays |url=https://www.linux.com/news/linux-as-a-screensaver-for-windows-the-gift-of-open-source-games-and-sboms-for-the-holidays/ |access-date=2026-05-19 |publisher=Linux.com}}</ref>

:* A research paper published on ResearchGate<ref>{{cite web |title=Linux screensaver for Windows |url=https://www.researchgate.net/publication/272094609_Linux_screensaver_for_Windows |access-date=2026-05-19 |publisher=ResearchGate}}</ref>

:A demonstration video is available on YouTube.<ref>{{cite web |title=Linux as Windows Screensaver |url=https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J7Jc7uPmLx8 |access-date=2026-05-19 |publisher=YouTube}}</ref>

:## Availability

:Media kits for the project are distributed through:

:* Internet Archive<ref>{{cite web |title=Linux Screensaver Media Kits |url=https://archive.org/details/@chris_ward523 |access-date=2026-05-19 |publisher=Internet Archive}}</ref>

:* SourceForge<ref>{{cite web |title=Linux screensavers for Windows |url=https://sourceforge.net/projects/linux-screensavers-for-windows/ |access-date=2026-05-19 |publisher=SourceForge}}</ref>

:The source code and tools for generating screensavers are maintained on GitHub.<ref>{{cite web |title=Screensaver generation tools |url=https://github.com/tjcw/screensavers |access-date=2026-05-

19 |publisher=GitHub}}</ref> Project documentation is also available in a separate repository.<ref>{{cite web |title=Screensaver documentation |url=https://github.com/tjcw/screensaver-docs |access-date=2026-05-19 |publisher=GitHub}}</ref>

== References ==

{{reflist}}

== External links ==

* [[github:tjcw/screensavers|Screensaver generation tools]]

* [[github:tjcw/screensaver-docs|Project documentation]]

:[[Category:Linux]]

:[[Category:Screensavers]]

:[[Category:Virtualization software]]

:[[Category:Free software]]